Make the effort to cook up your own stock, as the flavor of the celeriac and hazelnuts in this pale, creamy soup is not strong enough to disguise any shortcomings.

celeriac and hazelnut soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 40 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
WITHOUT LEMON JUICE AND CREAM

3½oz (100g) shelled hazelnuts
3 tbsp butter
1 medium–large celeriac, coarsely diced
1 onion, chopped
2 tbsp long- or short-grain rice
1 quart (1 liter) hot chicken stock
salt and freshly ground black pepper
juice of ½ lemon
½ cup heavy cream

1 Preheat the oven to 375˚F (190˚C). Spread the hazelnuts out on a baking sheet and roast for 5–10 minutes or until they turn a shade darker and the skins flake off easily. Check regularly to prevent burning. Let them cool slightly, then rub off the skins.

2 Melt the butter in a large pan over low heat. Add the celeriac, onion, rice, and hazelnuts, turn to coat well, then cover and let sweat gently for 10–15 minutes, stirring once or twice. Pour in half the stock, season well with salt and freshly ground black pepper, and bring to a boil. Simmer gently for 15 minutes or until the celeriac and rice are tender.

3 Let the soup cool for a few minutes, then process until completely smooth in a blender, adding the remaining stock to thin the soup down. Return to the pan, stir in the lemon juice and then the cream, and reheat, being sure to taste and balance the seasoning. Serve hot and steaming.